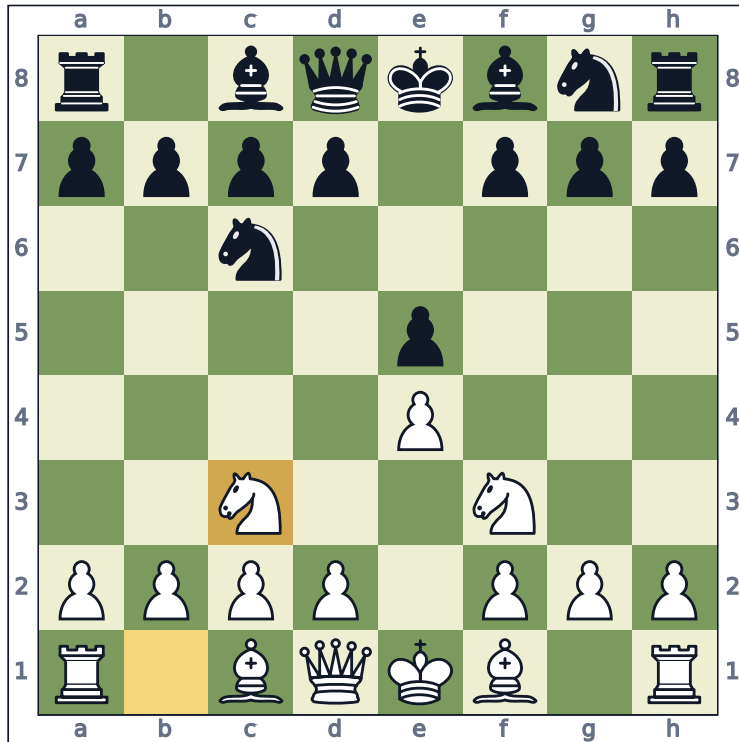


OPEN GAMES AFTER 1.E4 E5

Three Knights Opening

ECO C46 | 6 named lines in this code



Featured opening position - gold marks the last move

IS IT A GOOD OPENING?

Good and fully playable. The position remains within a normal opening balance for both sides.

ENGINE SNAPSHOT

+0.50 for White. A shallow opening score is a guide, not a forced result.

GAME CHARACTER

Principled and instructive: development and central breaks lead naturally into the middlegame.

WHAT THIS OPENING IS

C46 covers Three Knights Opening. Both sides contest the center directly, so development, king safety, and tactical accuracy become visible very early. The diagram uses the featured line Three Knights Opening.

DEFINING ROUTE

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Nc3

UNDERSTAND THE POSITION

What both sides are trying to achieve

WHITE'S GOALS

Develop with threats, prepare d4 under favorable conditions, castle, and use any lead in development before it disappears.

BLACK'S GOALS

Neutralize pressure on e5, complete development, and use ...d5 when it solves the center in one move.

PAWN BREAKS - THE ENGINE OF THE OPENING

White's d4 and Black's ...d5 are the central freeing breaks. The f7 and f2 squares demand tactical attention.

PIECE MAP

Knights normally reach f3/c3 and f6/c6 quickly; bishops choose active diagonals according to the central tension. The central pawn placement should decide where each bishop and knight belongs.

WHAT USUALLY GOES WRONG

Pawn grabbing and early queen moves are especially dangerous when the center can open with tempo. Recheck the center after every opponent deviation; opening names do not make moves automatic.

POSITION SNAPSHOT

Black moves next. Material is level. Central markers: White pawn on e4, Black pawn on e5.

WHO SHOULD STUDY IT?

Among the best openings for learning classical chess because strategic principles and tactics reinforce each other.

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named C46 line

This section preserves all 6 names and defining routes assigned to C46 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

001 Three Knights Opening

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Nc3

002 Three Knights Opening

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Nc3 Bb4

003 Three Knights Opening: Schlechter Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. Nd5 Nf6

004 Three Knights Opening: Steinitz Defense

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Nc3 g6

005 Three Knights Opening: Steinitz-Rosenthal Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Nc3 g6 4. d4 exd4 5. Nd5

006 Three Knights Opening: Winawer Defense

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Nc3 f5